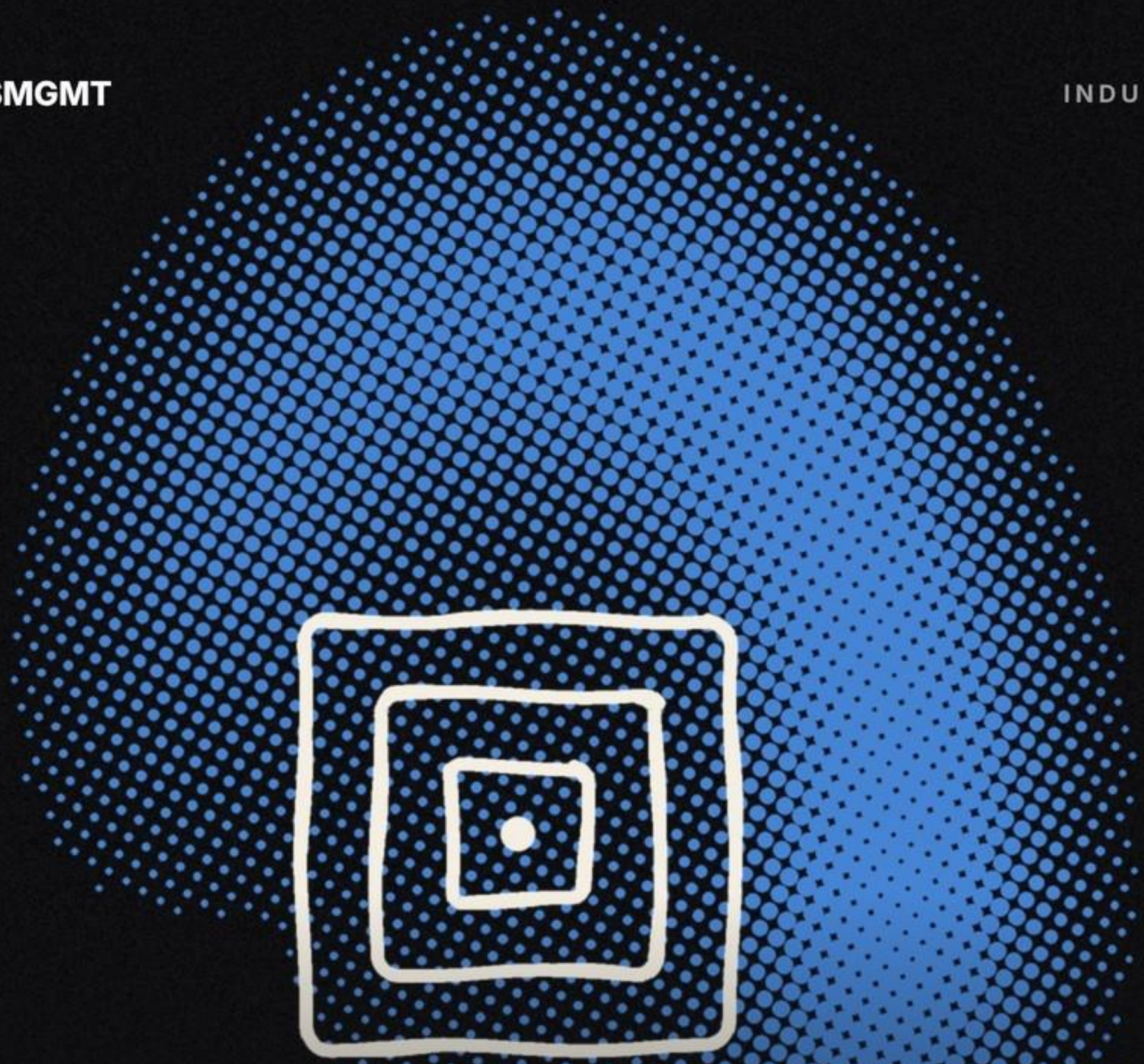


AS OF OCT 15, 2026

Who owns your music distributor in 2026?

We lined up the owners of 18 distributors against the two industry anti-fraud lists published this year.

By Benjamin Means · swipe →

TWO RULEBOOKS

Two anti-fraud rulebooks, three months apart

DistroKid endorsed the MFFA recommendations. It didn’t sign SII.

JUNE 2026

9

MFFA recommendations

Voluntary, “not binding regulations”

SEPT 14, 2026

27

Names on IFPI’s SII list

When we read it on Oct 15, 2026

MFFA recommendations v1.0 · IFPI, 2026 · read Oct 15, 2026

WHO SIGNED

CD Baby signed SII. DistroKid and TuneCore haven't.

As of October 15, 2026. CD Baby is the one owned by a major.

CD Baby

SIGNED

Universal Music Group, via Virgin Music Group

DistroKid

NOT ON THE LIST

CVC majority; Insight Partners and Create Music Group minority

TuneCore

NOT ON THE LIST

Believe

UnitedMasters

NOT ON THE LIST

Founder Steve Stoute plus VC backers

SII list, endstreamingfraud.com · MFFA endorsers · read Oct 15, 2026

THE SPLIT

Majors signed SII. The DIY names split.

Ownership doesn’t sort that split cleanly. Neither list says why anyone signed or didn’t.

CD Baby, AWAL	MAJOR-OWNED, SIGNED
Too Lost, Symphonic, Ditto, RouteNote	SIGNED
DistroKid, TuneCore, Believe, UnitedMasters, Amuse, LANDR, Stem, ONErpm, EmuBands, Vydia, Repost	NOT ON THE LIST

Distributors in our table that still operate · SII and MFFA lists read Oct 15, 2026



ENFORCEMENT

SII sets out no audit and no penalty

The MFFA calls its recommendations voluntary. Treat a signature as a stated intent.

Audit requirement	NONE
Reporting obligation	NONE
Penalty for a signatory that doesn’t follow it	NONE

DISTROKID

DistroKid since July

A deal closed, a lawsuit filed. These are UMG’s allegations. DistroKid disputes them, and no court has ruled.

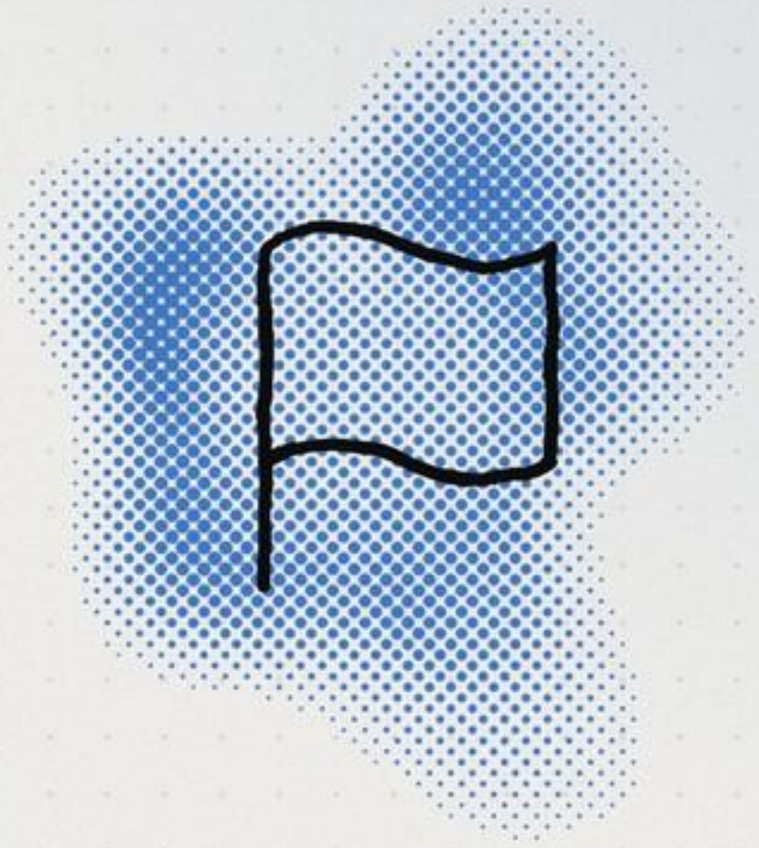
July 6 — **CVC agrees a majority stake**
Definitive agreement. Terms weren’t disclosed.

Sept 15 — **UMG sues in Delaware**
Alleging copyright infringement and deceptive trade practices.

Oct 28 — **MBW reports the deal closed**
Closed in Q3 2026. Create Music Group took a minority stake.

Dec 4 — **DistroKid’s response due**
After an extension.

CVC, 2026 · MBW, Oct 28, 2026 · D. Del. 1:26-cv-01156 · DMN, 2026



THE FEE

What a flagged track costs the artist

The flag sits on the track, whoever sent the plays.

€10

Spotify's fee, per TuneCore

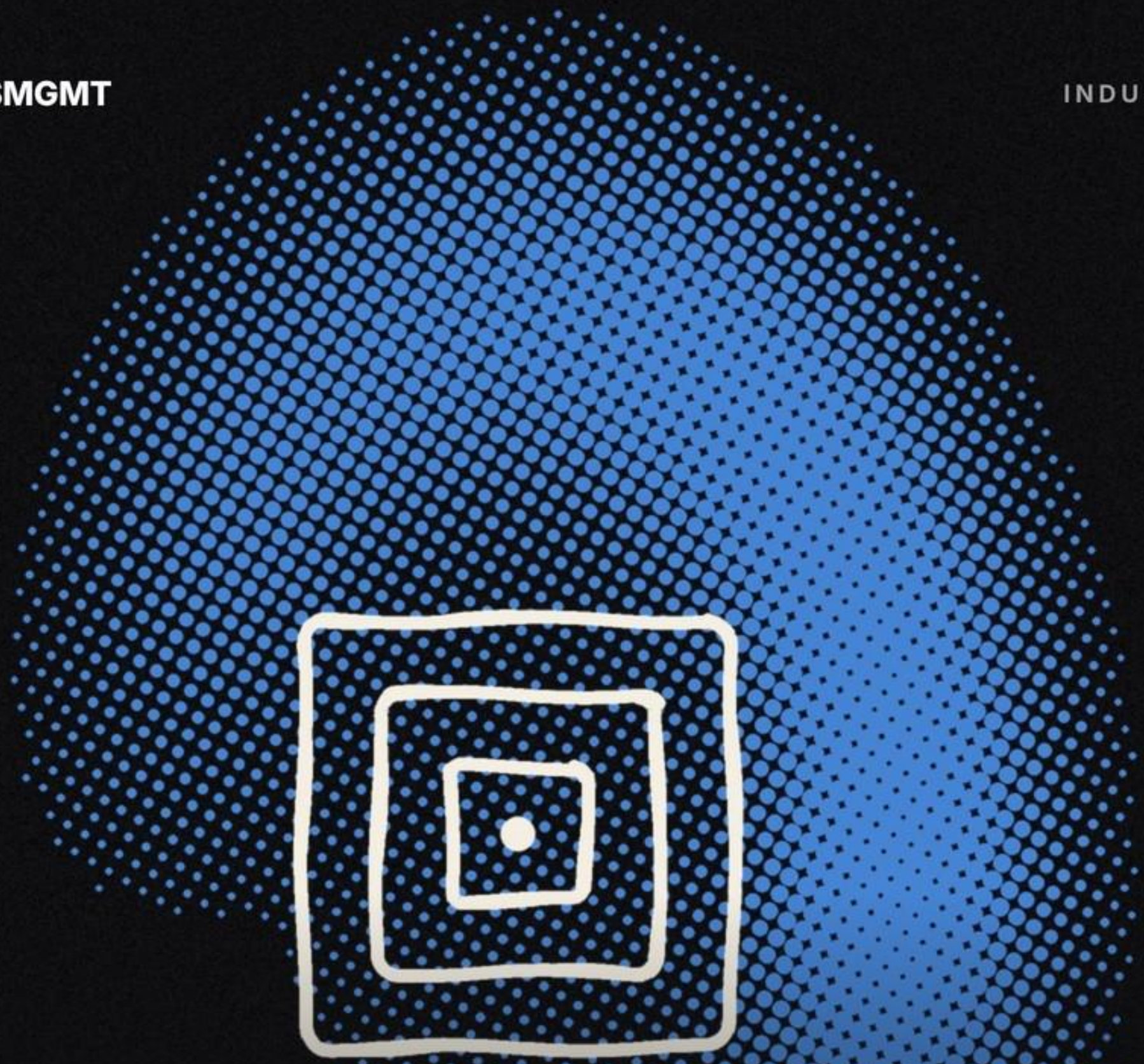
PER TRACK PER MONTH

about **$10–11**

The same fee at CD Baby

PER TRACK PER MONTH

TuneCore help center (undated) · CD Baby help center, Feb 26, 2026



OUR READ

Check who owns it. Read its fee page.

The full post has the table of 18 distributors and both anti-fraud lists, as of November 2026.

Full post at meansmgmt.com